



See the crisis coming — and act in time.

Fill the granary before the drought.

Hoji is a national foresight & decision-support engine. It reads the warning signs, forecasts where a crisis is heading, and helps our own planners get the most from the resources they already have. Its proven flagship is **food security** — and the same engine extends to floods, disease outbreaks, water stress and other national risks. Sovereign, open, and built at home.

Submitted by

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Zimbabwe

Open-source · built locally

THE PROBLEM

We see our crises coming. We just see them too late to act.

Drought and hunger, floods, disease outbreaks — Zimbabwe's biggest shocks are rarely a surprise. The signs build for weeks. Yet the warning usually arrives too late, buried in slow reports produced outside the country, after the season is lost. And even when a district is flagged, planners must stretch limited resources with no quick, shared way to see where action does the most good.

THE SOLUTION

Hoji — from early warning to a ready plan.

Hoji **forecasts** where risk is heading, district by district, then helps responders **plan**: enter the resources already set aside, and it shows where that effort protects the most people. Built first for **food security**.

ONE ENGINE, MANY NATIONAL RISKS

The pattern is always the same — **signals** → **risk score** → **forecast** → **response plan**. Build it once, apply it everywhere:



This is the Strategy's called-for "**AI disaster-warning system**", built as reusable national infrastructure — not a single-use app.

WHO IT IS FOR — AND HOW IT RESPECTS THEIR AUTHORITY

Hoji is a decision-support tool for those who plan the response: the Ministry of Lands & Agriculture, food-security and civil-protection officers, ZimVAC, health authorities and relief NGOs. **It supports existing decision-makers; it informs, it does not decide or override. Hozi never sets budgets and never tells government how to spend.** The planner is always in control.

In one line: the world's tools tell Zimbabwe what will happen. Hozi helps our own responders **act on it in time, with the resources they already have** — across every risk that matters, and it's ours.

TECHNICAL SPECIFICATION

A transparent engine — powered by AI where AI is strong.

- **Data layer:** district climate, crop & market signals — auto-fed from live feeds.
- **Risk engine:** a clear, weighted, *transparent* model — a 0–100 risk per district.
- **Forecast:** seasonal projection 1–3 months ahead with an honest confidence band.
- **Response Planner:** ranks where a given level of support cuts the most risk.
- **Interface:** a web map — time-slider, drill-down, planner — on any browser.

0.81

WEIGHTING CONSISTENCY CHECK VS THE DATASET'S OWN RISK SCORE (SYNTHETIC — NOT YET OUTCOME-VALIDATED)

We keep AI **out of the math** (so numbers stay auditable) and use it where it excels — **language:** it writes plain-language early-warning briefs in **English, chiShona & isiNdebele**, answers natural-language questions ("which districts need seed first?"), and turns messy field reports into clean signals.

AUTOMATED & LEAN (N8N)

The whole pipeline runs on **n8n** automation: it pulls new data on a schedule, refreshes the forecast, and pushes local-language alerts to district officers by **WhatsApp** — so a small team can run it nationally, and it updates itself.

THE FEATURE THAT SETS HOZI APART

The Response Planner — make every committed dollar count

Enter the resources already allocated and Hozì shows where they protect the most people per dollar, driest and least-served first. Global tools forecast the crisis; Hozì helps our own responders turn an existing budget into the most lives protected — without ever setting that budget.

INNOVATIVE FEATURES

Prediction → a plan.

A forecast becomes a fundable, comparable response.

Sovereign & open.

The first Zimbabwean-owned foresight engine — open-source, not a foreign black box.

Multi-hazard by design.

One engine for food, floods, disease and more.

Honest by design.

Shows its workings; states what it cannot know.

Locally fed.

District officers report ground truth foreign satellites can't see.

Speaks our languages.

Briefs & alerts in chiShona and isiNdebele.

Responsible AI: decision-support, not an oracle. Human-in-the-loop, transparent reasoning, honest about uncertainty — in line with the ethics of the National AI Strategy.

PROJECTED BENEFITS

Every \$1 of early action saves \$7. Hozì helps find it in time.

The World Food Programme estimates anticipatory action returns at least seven-to-one — the hard part is acting early and in the right order. In a working test on national sample data, Hozì flagged a sharp seasonal rise in risk and showed where existing effort would pay off most.

0 → 19

7×

3 mo.

- **Fewer lives lost:** seed, water, medicine and relief move *before* the crisis, not after.
- **Existing budgets go further:** the same resources guided to where they cut the most risk.
- **One shared truth:** ministries, NGOs and donors plan from the same live picture.

NATIONAL ALIGNMENT
ADVANCING THE NATIONAL AI STRATEGY

- Delivers the **Year-1 Food Security** priority.
- Builds the **"AI disaster-warning system"** it explicitly calls for.
- Supports **Pillar 3** (AI for service delivery & decisions).
- An analytics layer for **Project Pangolin**.
- Embodies **sovereignty, local language & responsible AI**.

ROADMAP
FROM FLAGSHIP TO PLATFORM

- **Now:** food-security engine + map + Response Planner (working).
- **3 months:** live feeds, all staples, chiShona/Ndebele briefs, one ministry pilot.
- **Nowcasting:** train on real **ZimVAC/IPC** outcomes (label sources already identified) to move from a transparent scorer to a learned, HungerMap-class nowcast.
- **12 months:** national roll-out, WhatsApp alerts, **floods & disease** modules, Pangolin integration.

WHY US

Curious Inq pairs senior design and storytelling with applied AI. Most technical entries are powerful but unreadable; most beautiful ones are thin. Hosi is both — a serious engine a Minister understands in thirty seconds.

Stage	Owner
Product, design, narrative	Nash Barara
Engine & automation	[Technical Lead]
Domain validation	[Domain Advisor]

Hosi does not replace the experts, and it does not set budgets. It gives our own planners a head start — turning scattered numbers into a clear plan, early enough to act, so fewer families go hungry and fewer communities are caught unprepared.